

➤ **What is PHP?**

- PHP is an open-source, interpreted, and object-oriented scripting language that can be executed at the server-side.
- It stands for Hypertext Preprocessor. PHP is well suited for web development. Therefore, it is used to develop web applications that executes on the server and generates the dynamic page.
- It is an interpreted language, i.e., there is no need for compilation.
- It is developed by Rasmus Lerdorf in 1994. PHP is the world's most popular server-side scripting programming language that is embedded in [HTML](#). Its latest version PHP 8.4.3, released on January 16th, 2025.
- PHP is a cross-platform language, capable of running on all major operating system platforms.

➤ **Why Learn PHP?**

Here, some of the major advantages of learning PHP:

- PHP is easy to learn and implement
- It is open-source and free (Cost-effective)
- Compatible with multiple platforms (works on Windows, Linux, macOS)
- It supports server-side scripting
- It can be easily embedded with HTML
- Supports database connectivity
- It comes up with large standard library
- Supports several frameworks like Laravel, CodeIgniter

➤ **What is a PHP File?**

- PHP files have the file extension .php
- PHP files can contain text, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and PHP code
- PHP code is executed on the server, and the result is returned to the browser as HTML

➤ **What Can PHP Do?**

- PHP can generate dynamic page content
- PHP can create, open, read, write, delete, and close files on the server
- PHP can collect form data

- PHP can send and receive cookies
- PHP can add, delete, modify data in your database
- PHP can be used to control user-access
- PHP can encrypt data

➤ **Applications of PHP**

PHP is a server-side language used to create dynamic and interactive websites. It is simple and widely used in web development. The main applications are:

1. **Web Application Development:**
PHP is used to build websites and web applications.
2. **Dynamic Website Creation:**
It allows websites to change content based on user actions.
3. **E-commerce Websites:**
PHP is used to create online shopping websites with features like cart and payment.
4. **Content Management Systems (CMS):**
It helps users easily create and manage website content without deep technical knowledge.
5. **Database-Driven Applications:**
PHP works with databases to store and retrieve information.
6. **Form Handling:**
PHP processes user input collected through forms, validates it, and stores it securely.
7. **User Authentication:**
PHP helps in implementing secure login and registration systems, managing user sessions, and controlling access to different parts of a website.
8. **API Development:**
It helps connect different applications and services.